[METRIC]
A-A-2174A
August 25, 1993
SUPERSEDING
A-A-2174
March 28,1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOWEL, PAPER (DENTAL)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all Federal Agencies.

1. **SCOPE.** This Commercial Item Description covers paper towels for medical and dental use.

2. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.**

2.1 Style and Dimensions. Towels shall be three-ply construction with all plies fused together by embossing over the entire surface of the towel. The towels shall be furnished quarter-folded or eighth-folded, at the supplier's option. When unfolded, the towel shall comply with the following dimensions:

Length - 43.2 cm (17 inch) min. to 50.8 cm (20 inch) max.
Width - 30.5 cm (12 inch) min. to 43.2 cm (17 inch) max.

2.2 Workmanship. The towels shall be clean and free of holes, tears, cuts, dirt or any other defects which would adversely affect appearance or serviceability. Towels shall be uniform in size and color and trimmed squarely and and have clean, smooth edges without raggedness.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza New York, N.Y. 10278.

Distribution Statement A:
Approved for public release;
Distribution is unlimited.

FSC 8540

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.3 Physical Requirements.

TABLE I

CHARACTERISTIC	REQUIREMENT	TEST METHOD
Basis Weight g/m2,min. (lbs, 24 X 36-500)	49 (30)	T 410
Wet Tensile Strength MD, N/m (oz/inch) minimum	109 (10)	T 456
Dry Tensile Strength CD, N/m (oz/inch) minimum MD, N/m (oz/inch) minimum	131 (12) 328 (30)	T 404
Absorption Rate,0.1 ml water, seconds, maximum	7	T 432
Total absorption, avg,minimum	450%	Method A
pH, minimum	4.5	T 435
Brightness, percent, minimum	75	T 452

Test Method A. Ten towels shall be selected at random and conditioned in accordance with Tappi T 402. Weigh each specimen of size 10.1 cm x 10.1 cm, +/- 0.32 cm (4" x 4", +/- 1/8 ") and immerse specimens in distilled water at 25deg. C for 3 minutes +/- 10 seconds. Remove the specimens by lifting them at one corner until their surfaces are vertical to the floor, and allow the excess water to drain off for 60 +/- 10 seconds. Place each in a tared weighing bottle and reweigh. Calculate the percent absorption to the nearest one percent as follows:

$$\text{Percent absorption} = \frac{\text{Wet weight - Dry weight}}{\text{Dry weight}} \times 100$$

2.4 General Requirements.

2.4.1 Odor. Towels shall have no disagreeable odor, either wet or dry.

2.4.2 Color. Towels shall be white, light green or light blue, at the supplier's option.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.4.3 Finish. Towels shall be embossed.

3. Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, or color, in accordance with this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified (see Paragraph 7) the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, hypochlorite, or other chlorine containing compound. Certification of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

4. Regulatory Requirements. The paper used in the manufacture of the towels shall conform to the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations and the regulations promulgated therein.

5. Quality Assurance Provisions. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may utilize his own facilities or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans specified in Table II, unless otherwise stated. For the purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all towels submitted for inspection at one time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested.
For preparation for delivery examination, the sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container. For all other examinations, the sample unit shall be one towel, unless specified otherwise.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II

Examine	Inspection Level	AQL (% defect)/ Acceptance
Workmanship/ General	S-3	4.0
Dimensional/Style	S-4	2.5
Preparation for delivery	S-2	2.5
Physical Properties	per Tappi	per Tappi

6. Applicable Documents and Document Sources. The following documents form a part of this Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

6.1 Tappi Standards.

T 402 Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets and Related Products
T 404 Tensile Breaking Strength and Elongation of Paper and Paperboard (Using Pendulum-Type Tester)
T 410 Grammage of Paper and Paperboard(Weight per Unit Area)
T 432 Water Absorbency of Bibulous Paper
T 435 Hydrogen Ion Concentration (pH) of Paper Extracts (Hot Extraction Method)
T 452 Brightness of Pulp, Paper and Paperboard (Directional Reflectance at 457 nm)
T 456 Wet Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard

Copies of Tappi Standards are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, PO Box 105113, Atlanta, Ga 30348.

6.2 Federal Standards.

Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, Handbooks, and Commercial Item Descriptions (CIDs), as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

Single copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications required by activities outside the Federal

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, D. C.; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; For Worth; Houston; Denver; Los Angeles; San Francisco; and Auburn, WA. They may also be obtained from: GSA Specifications Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20407.

6.3 Military Standards.

MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the U. S. Navy, Naval Publications and Form Center, Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

6.4 Code of Federal Regulations, Title 21

Copies of the U.S. Code of Federal Regulations may be purchased with a VISA, Master Card, or prepaid check through:
Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402
Phone (202) 783-3238

When ordering, ask for:
Title 21, Parts 170-199
Stock Number: 869-017-00-068-0

7. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
(2) Packaging, packing and marking
(3) Bleaching (see Paragraph 3)

MILITARY INTEREST:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.